

Sprint Review and Retrospective

SNHU Travel Project

CS 250 Final Project

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The SNHU Travel project showed how Scrum-Agile can help ChadaTech move away from a strictly waterfall development model. As Scrum Master, I reviewed how the team roles, user stories, communication, organizational tools, and Scrum events supported the project. The strongest lesson from the pilot was that Agile worked well because it allowed the team to deliver work in smaller pieces, inspect progress often, and adjust when the customer-facing travel application needed changes.

Applying Roles

The Product Owner contributed by keeping the product backlog focused on business value and customer needs. For SNHU Travel, that meant prioritizing features that helped users search for travel options and understand available services. The Scrum Master contributed by facilitating Sprint Planning, Daily Scrum, Sprint Review, and Retrospective meetings while helping remove blockers. The Developers contributed by building, testing, and improving the product increment during each sprint. These roles helped the team succeed because each role had a clear purpose while still supporting shared accountability. Scrum defines the team around the Product Owner, Scrum Master, and Developers, which made the project responsibilities easier to understand (Scrum Alliance, 2025).

Completing User Stories

Scrum-Agile helped user stories come to completion because the work was divided into smaller, testable features. Instead of trying to finish the whole SNHU Travel application at one

time, the team could select the most valuable backlog items for a sprint. A user story such as allowing a traveler to search for vacation options could be planned, built, tested, reviewed, and then improved based on feedback. This approach supported the SDLC because planning, analysis, design, development, testing, and review happened repeatedly throughout the project. Agile was useful because progress was measured through working increments and customer feedback rather than only through completed documentation (Project Management Institute & Agile Alliance, 2025).

Handling Interruptions

Scrum-Agile also helped when the project was interrupted or changed direction. In a waterfall project, a major change late in the process can force the team to redo earlier phases. In Scrum, the team can inspect the change, discuss the impact, and place the new work into the product backlog. For example, if SNHU Travel requested a new filter for trip searches after seeing an early version, the Product Owner could reorder the backlog instead of stopping the whole project. Sprint Reviews and Retrospectives created regular opportunities to inspect and adapt, which is a major reason Scrum was effective for this pilot (Schwaber & Sutherland, 2020).

Communication

Communication was important because Scrum depends on frequent, clear updates. A strong Daily Scrum update would be: “Yesterday I finished the destination search layout. Today I will connect the results to the data. I am blocked because I need confirmation on which filters should be included.” This message is effective because it explains completed work, planned work, and a blocker. Sprint Review communication was also helpful because stakeholders could respond to working features instead of guessing from a document. These communication habits encouraged collaboration and helped the team avoid confusion.

Organizational Tools

The most useful organizational tools were the product backlog, sprint backlog, task board, Definition of Done, and Scrum events. The product backlog captured all possible work, while the sprint backlog focused the team on the current sprint. The task board showed what was not started, in progress, in testing, and complete. These tools helped because they made progress visible. Scrum events made the tools more effective because Sprint Planning selected the work, Daily Scrum monitored progress, Sprint Review gathered feedback, and the Retrospective improved the process.

Evaluating the Agile Process

The Scrum-Agile approach had more advantages than disadvantages for the SNHU Travel project. The advantages included flexibility, early feedback, visible progress, and stronger collaboration. The disadvantages were that Scrum required frequent communication, active stakeholder involvement, and a well-maintained backlog. If the Product Owner was unavailable or priorities were unclear, the team could lose focus. Even with those challenges, Scrum-Agile was the best approach because SNHU Travel was a customer-facing project where feedback mattered. Waterfall would have worked better if the requirements were fixed from the beginning, but Agile was stronger for this project because the team could adapt as stakeholders learned more about what they wanted. Professional guidance also recognizes that Agile is better suited for changing requirements, while waterfall is more structured and sequential (Project-Management.com, 2026). Based on this pilot, ChadaTech should continue using Scrum-Agile for projects where customer feedback, flexibility, and incremental delivery are important.

References

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